

FERROCALM YOUR LIFE



SUMPTUOUS SOUPS & SALADS

A HHA PUBLICATOIN



Soup & Salad Nutrition Powerhouses

Soups and salads are a great make-ahead addition to meals or as quick snacks. When eaten at the beginning of a meal they boost feelings of fullness and pack a powerful nutrient punch. They are a great way to increase fruit and vegetable intake as only a small portion is needed to get an extra couple of portions of your daily intake.

Recipe measurements guide T = Tablespoon t = teaspoon

LENTIL SOUP



Ingredients
Homemade stock or veggie stockpot
150g red lentils
6 carrots, finely chopped
2 medium leeks, sliced
a small handful of chopped parsley, to serve

Method
Heat the stock in a large pan and add the lentils. Bring to the boil and allow the lentils to soften for a few minutes.
Add the carrots and leeks and season. Bring to the boil, then reduce the heat, cover and simmer for 45-60 mins until the lentils have broken down. Scatter over the parsley and serve with buttered bread, if you like.

MUSHROOM SOUP



Ingredients

90g butter
2 medium onions, roughly chopped
1 garlic clove, crushed
500g mushrooms, finely chopped (chestnut or button mushrooms work well)
2 tbsp plain flour
litre of chicken stock
1 bay leaf
4 tbsp single cream OR vegan cream

Method

Heat the butter in a large saucepan and cook the onions and garlic until soft but not browned, about 8-10 mins.
Add the mushrooms and cook over high heat for another 3 mins until softened. Sprinkle over the flour and stir to combine. Pour in the chicken stock, bring the mixture to a boil, then add the bay leaf and simmer for another 10 mins.
Remove and discard the bay leaf, then remove the mushroom mixture from the heat and blitz using a hand blender until smooth.

CELERY SOUP



Ingredients
2 tbsp olive oil
300g celery, sliced finely
1 garlic clove, peeled
200g potatoes, peeled and cut into chunks
500ml vegetable stock
100ml milk or almond milk

Method
Heat the oil in a large saucepan over medium heat, tip in the celery, garlic and potatoes and coat in the oil. Add a splash of water and a big pinch of salt and cook, stirring regularly for 15 mins, adding a little more water if the veg begins to stick.
Pour in the vegetable stock and bring to a boil, then turn the heat down and simmer for 20 mins further, until the potatoes are falling apart and the celery is soft. Use a stick blender to purée the soup, then pour in the milk and blitz again. Season to taste. Serve with crusty bread.

CAULIFLOWER SOUP



Ingredients

1 large cauliflower (1.5kg), cut into florets
½ tbsp ground cumin
2 tbsp olive oil, plus extra for drizzling
4 thyme sprigs
1 onion, finely chopped
1 celery stick, finely chopped
1 garlic clove, crushed
750-850ml veg or chicken stock
100ml single cream or vegan cream
½ small bunch of parsley, finely chopped

Method

Heat the oven to 220C/200C fan/gas 7. Toss the cauliflower florets in a roasting tin with 1 tbsp olive oil, cumin and thyme. Roast for 15 mins or until golden and tender. Discard the thyme. Heat the remaining oil in a saucepan with the onion and celery and fry over medium heat for 10 mins or until softened. Add the garlic and cook for 1 min. Stir through most of the cauliflower, reserving some to top the soup with later. Add 750ml of the stock to the pan and bring to a simmer. Cook for 10 mins.

BUTTERNUT SQUASH SOUP



Ingredients

½ butternut squash, peeled and chopped into 4cm cubes
½ tbsp olive oil1 onion, diced
1 small garlic clove, thinly sliced
1 mild red chilli, deseeded and finely chopped
400ml vegetable stock
2 tbsp crème fraîche, plus more to serve

Method

Heat the oven to 200C/180C fan/gas 6. Toss the butternut squash in a roasting tin with olive oil. Season and roast for 30 mins, turning once during cooking, until golden and soft. Put the roast squash into a soup maker, or blender along with the onion, garlic, most of the chilli and all the stock. Make sure you don't fill the mixer above the max fill line. Press the soup function
Once the cycle is complete, season well, and add the crème fraîche. Blend briefly once again until the soup is creamy. Add a little extra stock or boiling water if you prefer a thinner soup, and serve in bowls with a swirl of crème fraîche and the reserved chopped chilli.

Tomato Soup



Ingredients
1 onion
1-2 garlic cloves
2 Tins chopped tomatoes
½ head broccoli
2 carrots
1 T coconut oil

Method
Place coconut oil in a medium-sized pot and turn on medium heat. Chop onion, garlic, carrots and broccoli. Add vegetables to the pot and cook until soft (about 5 minutes), stirring to prevent sticking. Add tinned tomatoes and salt/pepper to taste. Turn heat down to low and let simmer for 5-10 minutes. Blend the soup until smooth and serve with bread or cheese quesadillas on the side.

MEXICAN BEAN SOUP WITH GUACAMOLE



Ingredients

2 tsp oil
1 large onion, finely chopped
1 red pepper, cut into chunks
2 garlic cloves, chopped
2 t mild chilli powder
1 t ground coriander
1 t ground cumin
400g can chopped tomatoes
400g can black beans
1 t vegetable bouillon powder
1 small avocado handful chopped coriander
1 lime, juiced
½ red chilli, deseeded and finely chopped (optional)

Method

Heat the oil in a medium pan, add the onion (reserving 1 tbsp to make the guacamole later) and pepper and fry, stirring frequently, for 10 mins. Stir in the garlic and spices, then tip in the tomatoes and beans with their liquid, half a can of water and the bouillon powder. Simmer, covered, for 15 mins.
Meanwhile, peel and de-stone the avocado and tip into a bowl, add the remaining onion, coriander and lime juice with a little chilli (if using) and mash well. Ladle the soup into two bowls, top with the guacamole and serve.



Salads Don't Need To Be Boring

Salads are often seen as boring, which is sad because salads can be so much more than just iceberg lettuce, tomatoes and cucumber. I hope these beautiful, nutritious salads tempt you into loving their flavours, smells and textures.

BLACK BEAN AND AVOCADO SALAD



Ingredients

Dressing. - 4 tbsp lime juice & 7 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
3-4 jalapeño peppers (or 1 red chilli), finely chopped, to taste
1 garlic clove, minced plus pinch ground cumin, salt and freshly ground black pepper

Salad - 3 x 400g tins cooked black beans, drained
4 medium tomatoes, chopped into wedges, seeds removed (or 16 cherry tomatoes, halved)
1 large red pepper, stalk and seeds removed, sliced into thin strips1 red onion, thinly sliced5 spring onions, trimmed and thinly sliced (or
1 small red onion, thinly sliced)200g/7oz fresh watercress, tough stems snipped into half and a large handful of chopped fresh coriander
2 large ripe avocados, skin and seeds removed, cut into cubes

Method

Put all of the dressing ingredients in a jam jar, replace the lid and shake until well combined.
For the salad, rinse the black beans under cold running water and drain. Put in a large mixing bowl and pour over half of the dressing. Add the remaining salad ingredients, apart from the watercress and avocado and stir well to combine. Divide the watercress among 4 plates. Spoon the salad on top, then cover with the avocado cubes. Drizzle dressing over each portion.

INDIAN SALAD



Ingredients
225g/8oz cucumber, cut into ½cm cubes
225g/8oz tomatoes, cut into ½cm cubes
100g/3½oz red onions, cut into ½cm cubes
50g/1¾oz pomegranate seeds
2–3 green chillies, finely chopped
¼ tsp salt
4 T lime or lemon juice
fresh mint sprigs, to garnish

Method
Mix the cucumber, tomatoes, onions, pomegranate seeds and chilli together in a large bowl. Season with salt, then dress with lime or lemon juice. Serve immediately, garnished with a few fresh mint sprigs.

CURRIED CHICKEN AND RICE SALAD



Ingredients

75g wholegrain long-grain rice
2 tsp medium curry powder
100g long-stem broccoli, trimmed and cut into short lengths
1/2 chicken stock cube
1 chicken breast, boned and skinned
1 small onion, half thinly sliced, half finely chopped
1 bay leaf
15g flaked almonds, toasted
1 small eating apple, cored, halved and thinly sliced
100g cherry tomatoes, halved
3 heaped tbsp roughly chopped fresh coriander
1/2 lemon, juice only
salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 t coconut oil for cooking

Method

Half-fill a medium saucepan with water and bring to a boil. Add the rice and one teaspoon of curry powder. Cook for 25 minutes, or until tender. Add the broccoli and cook for a further two minutes. Drain in a colander and rinse under cold running water until cold.

Meanwhile, half-fill a small saucepan with water, add the stock cube and bring to a boil, stirring until the stock dissolves. Add the chicken, the sliced onion and bay leaf and reduce the heat. Simmer for 15 minutes or until the chicken is cooked through. Drain in a sieve, reserving the cooking liquor. Set the chicken aside to cool. Return the pan to heat, add oil and add the chopped onion. Cook over low heat for three minutes, stirring. Add the remaining curry powder and stir for a further few seconds.

Pour 200ml of reserved cooking liquor into the pan and bring to a simmer. Cook the onion for 5-6 minutes, or until most of the liquid has evaporated, stirring occasionally. Remove from the heat, spread across a plate and leave to cool for five minutes before transferring to the fridge until cold. Tear the chicken into pieces and place in a bowl. Tip the rice and broccoli on top, add the cooled spiced onions, almonds, apple and tomatoes. Scatter with the coriander and sprinkle with lemon juice. Season to taste and serve.

GREEK-STYLE EASY PEASY PASTA SALAD



Ingredients
85g pasta, such as penne or conchiglie
1/2 unwaxed lemon, finely grated zest and juice
1/4 red onion, finely chopped
1/2 T olive oil, ideally extra virgin
1/4 cucumber, peeled and cubed
100g cherry tomatoes, quartered
5g fresh basil, roughly chopped
60g feta, crumbled
handful pitted black olives
black pepper

Method.
Cook the pasta in a saucepan of boiling, salted water as per the packet instructions.

Whisk together the lemon zest and juice, red onion, oil and a generous amount of pepper. Drain the pasta in a colander and run it under a cold tap until cooled.
Stir the dressing, cucumber, tomatoes, basil, feta and olives, if using, into the pasta and serve.

CARROT SALAD



Ingredients
4-6 grated carrots
Large handful walnuts or almonds
1 Apple or large handful of raisins
3 T orange juice
2 T chia (optional)

Method
Mix ingredients together and serve chilled



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